

INTERNATIONAL CATHOLIC MASS



20 DECEMBER 2025

4TH SUNDAY OF ADVENT

YEAR A

INTRODUCTORY RITES

ENTRANCE SONG (*Please stand*)

GREETING

P - In the name of the Father, and of the Son, and of the Holy Spirit.

All - Amen!

P - Praise and honor to God who calls us to be partners in the realization of His plan. May His grace and peace be with you all.

All - And with Your Spirit.

PENITENTIAL RITE

P - Coming together as God's family on this last Sunday of Advent, let us humbly ask the Lord's forgiveness of our past sins, and the grace to be always ready to cooperate with Him. (*Pause*)

All - I confess to almighty God, and to you, my brothers and sisters, that I have greatly sinned, in my thoughts and in my words, in what I have done, and in what I have failed to do; (*striking the breast*) through my fault, through my fault, through my grievous fault; therefore I ask blessed Mary ever-Virgin, all the Angels and Saints, and you my brothers and sisters, to pray for me to the Lord our God.

P - May almighty God have mercy on us, forgive us our sins, and bring us to everlasting life.

All - Amen!

KYRIE (*To be sung*)

OPENING PRAYER

P - Pour forth, we beseech you, O Lord, your grace into our hearts, that we, to whom the Incarnation of Christ your Son was made known by the message of an Angel, may by his Passion and Cross be brought to the glory of his Resurrection.

Who lives and reigns with you in the unity of the Holy Spirit, one God, for ever and ever.

All - Amen! *(Please be seated)*

LITURGY OF THE WORD

FIRST READING

A reading from the Prophet Isaiah

Isaiah 7:10-14

In those days:

The Lord spoke to Ahaz: "Ask a sign of the Lord your God; let it be deep as Sheol or high as heaven." But Ahaz said, "I will not ask, and I will not put the Lord to the test." And he said, "Hear then, O house of David! Is it too little for you to weary men, that you weary my God also? Therefore the Lord himself will give you a sign. Behold, the virgin shall conceive and bear a son, and shall call his name Immanuel."

The Word of the Lord!

All - Thanks be to God!

RESPONSORIAL PSALM

Psalm 24:1-2,3-4,5-6

R - Let the Lord enter; he is king of glory.

- 1. The Lord's are the earth and its fullness; the world and those who dwell in it. For he founded it upon the seas and established it upon the rivers. R.**
- 2. Who can ascend the mountain of the LORD? or who may stand in his holy place? One whose hands are sinless, whose heart is clean, who desires not what is vain. R.**

3. He shall receive a blessing from the LORD, a reward from God his savior. Such is the race that seeks for him, that seeks the face of the God of Jacob. R.

SECOND READING

A reading from the Letter of Saint Paul to the Romans Romans 1:1-7

Paul, a servant of Christ Jesus, called to be an apostle, set apart for the gospel of God, which he promised beforehand through his prophets in the holy Scriptures, concerning his Son, who was descended from David according to the flesh and was declared to be the Son of God in power according to the Spirit of holiness by his resurrection from the dead, Jesus Christ our Lord, through whom we have received grace and apostleship to bring about the obedience of faith for the sake of his name among all the nations, including you who are called to belong to Jesus Christ, To all those in Rome who are loved by God and called to be saints: Grace to you and peace from God our Father and the Lord Jesus Christ.

The Word of the Lord!

All - Thanks be to God!

Gospel Acclamation (*Please stand*)

All - Alleluia! Alleluia!

“The virgin shall conceive, and bear a son, and they shall name him Emmanuel.”

All - Alleluia! Alleluia!

GOSPEL

P - The Lord be with you!

All - And with your spirit!

P - A reading from the holy Gospel according to Matthew

Matthew 1:18-24

All - Glory to you, O Lord!

Now the birth of Jesus Christ took place in this way. When his mother Mary had been betrothed to Joseph, before they came together, she was found to be with child from the Holy Spirit. And her husband Joseph, being a just man and unwilling to put her to shame,

resolved to send her away quietly. But as he considered these things, behold, an angel of the Lord appeared to him in a dream, saying, "Joseph, son of David, do not fear to take Mary as your wife, for that which is conceived in her is from the Holy Spirit. She will bear a son, and you shall call his name Jesus, for he will save his people from their sins." All this took place to fulfil what the Lord had spoken by the prophet: "Behold, the virgin shall conceive and bear a son, and they shall call his name Emmanuel" (which means, God with us). When Joseph woke from sleep, he did as the angel of the Lord commanded him: he took his wife.

The Gospel of the Lord!

All - Praise to you, Lord Jesus Christ!

HOMILY (*Please be seated*)

PROFESSION OF FAITH - (*Please stand*)

I believe in God, the Father almighty, Creator of heaven and earth, and in Jesus Christ, his only Son, our Lord,

(Please PAUSE and make a profound bow)

who was conceived by the Holy Spirit, born of the Virgin Mary, suffered under Pontius Pilate, was crucified, died and was buried; He descended into hell; on the third day He rose again from the dead; He ascended into heaven, and is seated at the right hand of God the Father almighty; from there He will come to judge the living and the dead.

I believe in the Holy Spirit, the holy catholic Church, the communion of saints, the forgiveness of sins, the resurrection of the body, and life everlasting. Amen.

PRAYER OF THE FAITHFUL

P - The Lord constantly invites us to be His partners in the implementation of His plan. Aware of our limitations and weaknesses, let us ask His help for ourselves and all those dear to us. For every petition, let our response be:

R - Lord, may Your will be done!

1. That the Church may fully trust in God, especially in times of trial, and be constantly faithful to Him, let us pray! **R.**
2. That all those in a position of authority in the Church may always offer a shining example of cooperation with the Lord in carrying out His plan, let us pray! **R.**
3. That those who are suffering in whatever way may find in the solidarity of their relatives and friends the strength they need to accept God's plan for them, let us pray! **R.**
4. That the policy-makers of our society may always plan activities that are fully in accordance with God's law and plans, let us pray! **R.**
5. That our youth and all those who are planning their future may do so after discerning God's will through prayer and the advice of wise persons, let us pray! **R.**
6. That all of us may be faithful to our commitment to readily cooperate in the fulfillment of God's plan, let us pray! **R.**
7. For our personal intentions... (a moment of silence)... Let us pray! **R.**

P - Lord God, grant us the grace to imitate the example of Jesus, Your obedient Son, and make our lives a faithful instrument of Your plan. You who live and reign forever and ever.

All - Amen! (*Please be seated*)

LITURGY OF THE EUCHARIST

PREPARATION OF THE GIFTS (*Please stand*)

P - Pray, brethren, that my sacrifice and yours may be acceptable to God, the almighty Father.

All - May the Lord accept the sacrifice at your hands, for the praise and glory of his name, for our good and the good of all his holy Church.

PRAYER OVER THE OFFERINGS

P - May the Holy Spirit, O Lord, sanctify these gifts laid upon your altar, just as he filled with his power the womb of the Blessed Virgin Mary. Through Christ our Lord.

All - Amen!

PREFACE

P - The Lord be with you!

All - And with your spirit!

P - Lift up your hearts!

All - We lift them up to the Lord!

P - Let us give thanks to the Lord our God!

All - It is right and just!

P - It is truly right and just, our duty and our salvation, always and everywhere to give you thanks, Lord, holy Father, almighty and eternal God, through Christ our Lord.

For all the oracles of the prophets foretold him, the Virgin Mother longed for him with love beyond all telling, John the Baptist sang of his coming and proclaimed his presence when he came.

It is by his gift that already we rejoice at the mystery of his Nativity, so that he may find us watchful in prayer and exultant in his praise.

And so, with Angels and Archangels, with Thrones and Dominions, and with all the hosts and Powers of heaven, we sing the hymn of your glory, as without end we acclaim:

All – Holy, holy, holy Lord, God of hosts. Heaven and earth are full of your glory. Hosanna in the highest! Blessed is he who comes in the name of the Lord. Hosanna in the highest! *(Please kneel.)*

MEMORIAL ACCLAMATION

P - The mystery of faith!

All - We proclaim your Death, O Lord, and profess your Resurrection until you come again!

COMMUNION RITE

LORD'S PRAYER *(Please stand)*

P - At the Savior's command and formed by divine teaching, we dare to say:

All - Our Father who art in heaven, hallowed be thy name; thy kingdom come, thy will be done on earth as it is in heaven. Give us this day our daily bread, and forgive us our trespasses, as we forgive

those who trespass against us; and lead us not into temptation, but deliver us from evil.

P - Deliver us, Lord, we pray, from every evil, graciously grant peace in our days, that by the help of your mercy, we may be always free from sin and safe from all distress, as we await the blessed hope and the coming of our Saviour, Jesus Christ.

All - For the kingdom, the power, and the glory are yours, now and for ever.

SIGN OF PEACE

P - Lord Jesus Christ, you said to your Apostles: I leave you peace, my peace I give you. Look not on our sins, but on the faith of your Church, and grant us the peace and unity of your kingdom where you live forever and ever.

All - Amen!

P - The peace of the Lord be with you always.

All - And with your spirit.

P - Let us offer each other the sign of peace.

BREAKING OF THE BREAD *(Please kneel)*

All - Lamb of God, you take away the sins of the world: have mercy on us. Lamb of God, you take away the sins of the world: have mercy on us. Lamb of God, you take away the sins of the world: grant us peace.

COMMUNION

P - Behold the Lamb of God, behold him who takes away the sins of the world. Blessed are those called to the Supper of the Lamb.

All - Lord, I am not worthy that you should enter under my roof, but only say the word and my soul shall be healed.

COMMUNION SONG

PRAYER AFTER COMMUNION *(Please stand)*

P - Having received this pledge of eternal redemption, we pray, almighty God, that, as the feast day of our salvation draws ever nearer, so we may press forward all the more eagerly to the worthy

celebration of the mystery of your Son's Nativity. Who lives and reigns for ever and ever.

All - Amen!

CONCLUDING RITES

P - The Lord be with you.

All - And with your spirit!

P - May almighty God bless you: the Father, and the Son, and the Holy Spirit.

All - Amen!

P - Go in peace, glorifying the Lord by your life.

All - Thanks be to God!

ANGELUS PRAYER *(Please stand)*

**In the name of the Father, and of the Son, and of the Holy Spirit.
Amen.**

L : The Angel of the Lord declared unto Mary.

All : And She conceived of the Holy Spirit.

L : Hail Mary, full of grace, the Lord is with Thee.

**Blessed art thou among women and blessed is the fruit of
Thy Womb, Jesus.**

**All : Holy Mary, Mother of God, pray for us sinners,
Now and at the hour of our death.**

L : Behold the handmaid of the Lord.

All : Be It done unto me according to Thy word.

L : Hail Mary, full of grace, the Lord is with Thee.

**Blessed art thou among women and blessed is the fruit of
Thy Womb, Jesus.**

**All : Holy Mary, Mother of God, pray for us sinners,
Now and at the hour of our death.**

L : And the Word was made Flesh.

All : And dwelt among us.

L : Hail Mary, full of grace, the Lord is with Thee.

**Blessed art thou among women and blessed is the fruit of
Thy Womb, Jesus.**

**All : Holy Mary, Mother of God, pray for us sinners,
Now and at the hour of our death.**

L : Pray for us, O Holy Mother of God.

All : That we may be made worthy of the promises of Christ.

Let's us Pray :

**Pour fourth, we beseech Thee, O Lord, Thy grace into our hearts,
that we to whom the Incarnation of Christ Thy Son was made known
by the message of an angel, may by His Passion and Cross be
brought to the Glory of His Resurrection.**

Through the same Christ our Lord. Amen.

Ye Gates, Lift Up Your Heads On High (*Opening Song*)

1. Ye gates, lift up your heads on high; ye doors that last for aye,
Be lifted up that so the King of glory enter may.
But who the glory is the King? The mighty Lord is this;
Ev'n that same Lord, that great in might and strong in battle is.
Ev'n that same Lord, that great in might and strong in battle is.
Hallelujah, Hallelujah, Hallelujah, Hallelujah, Hallelujah,
Amen, Amen, Amen.

2. Ye gates, lift up your head; ye doors, doors that do last for aye,
Be lifted up that so the King of glory enter may.
But who is he that is the King? The King of Glory? Who is this?
The Lord of hosts, and none but He, The King of glory is.
The Lord of hosts, and none but He, The King of glory is.
Hallelujah, Hallelujah, Hallelujah, Hallelujah, Hallelujah,
Amen, Amen, Amen.

Kyrie

Cantor : Kyri-e, e-le-ison.____

All : Kyri-e, e-le-ison.____

Cantor : Chri-ste, e-le-ison.____

All : Chri-ste, e-leison.

Cantor : Kyri-e, e-le-ison.____

All : Kyri-e, e-le-ison.____

Zion's Daughter, O Be Glad (*Offertory Song*)

1. Zion's daughter, O be glad and rejoice, Jerusalem!
Lo! Thy King doth come to thee;
Lo! He comes, the Prince of peace!
Zion's daughter, O be glad and rejoice, Jerusalem!

2. Glad hosana! David's son, of thy nation blest art Thou.
Thy eternal kingdom found;
Glad hosana! Lord on high!
Glad hosana! David's son, of thy nation blest art Thou.

3. Glad hosana! Prince of peace, now we greet Thee, Sov'reign mild.
Ever stands Thy Throne of peace;
Thou the heav'nly Fathers Child!
Glad hosana! Prince of peace, now we greet Thee, Sov'reign mild.

Sanctus

Sanctus, Sanctus, Sanctus,
Dominus deus sabaoth.
Pleni sunt Caeli et terra gloria tua.
Hosanna in excelsis.

Benedictus qui venit in nomine Domini.
Hosanna in excelsis.

Our Father

Our Father, who art in heaven,
Hallowed be thy name,
Thy kingdom come, thy will be done
On earth as it is in heaven.
Give us this day our daily bread,
And forgive us our trespasses
As we forgive those who trespass against us,
And lead us not into temptation,
But deliver us, deliver us from evil.

Agnus Dei

Agnus Dei, qui tollis peccata mundi
Miserere nobis.
Agnus Dei, qui tollis peccata mundi
Miserere nobis.
Agnus Dei, qui tollis peccata mundi
Dona nobis pacem.

Prayer of St. Francis (*Communion Song*)

Lord, make me an instrument of Thy peace,
Where there is hatred, let me show love,
Where there is injury, Thy pardon, Lord
Where there is doubt, let there be faith

Oh Lord, make me an instrument of Thy peace,
Where there is despair, let me bring hope
Where there is darkness, let there be light
Where there is sadness, let there be joy
O Divine Master, grant that I may not so much seek
To be consoled as to console
To be understood as to understand
To be loved as to love.

O Lord, make me an instrument of Thy peace,
Where there is hatred, let me show love,
For it is in giving that we receive
And it is in pardoning that we are pardoned
And it is in dying that we are born
To eternal life, to eternal life
Lord, make me an instrument of Thy peace,
An instrument of Thy peace. Amen.

Fling Wide the Door (Communion Song)

1. Fling wide the door, unbar the gate:
The King of glory comes in state;
The Lord of lords and King of kings,
The saviour of the world,
Who brings his great salvation to the earth.
So raise a shout of holy mirth
and praise our God and Lord.
Creator, Spirit, Word.

2. He is the rock of our belief,
The heart of mercy's gentleself.
His kingly crown is holiness;
His scepter is his loveliness;
He brings our sorrows to an end.
Now gladly praise our King and friend,
And worship Him with song
For saving us from wrong.

3. Oh happy towns and blessed lands
That live by their true king's commands.
And blessed be the hearts He rules,
The humble places where He dwells.
He is the rightful Son of bliss
Who fills our lives and makes us His,
Creator of the world,
Our only strength for good.

4. Come, Lord, our Saviour, Jesus Christ;
Our hearts are open wide in trust.
Oh show us now your lovely grace,
Upon our sorrows shine your face,
And let your Holy Spirit guide our journey
In your grace so wide.
We praise your holy name,
From age to age the same!

O My Mind, Rejoice, Bear Witness (*Closing Song*)

O my mind, rejoice, bear witness,
Heart and soul, come take the lead;
All together praise God's goodness
And all He has done for me.
How He guards me all the day,
Send so many griefs away,
How from troubles and disgrace
He protects me with His grace.